

v0.4.4

(Note: you may push back on things I characterize as decided, here, if you think best)

Continued from v0.4.3 sec 1-7

7.3 - HIGHWAY borders all Median Reach, not just Home Median. Specific phrasings of Home Median here should be altered.

7.3 - we use Longitude in the opposite of standard geographical usage. Is this a problem?

7.3 - the Traverse and Longitudinal Crossings should be internal terms, and they are at root the same experience: Dodge hazards. Inspired by the access roads and U-turn areas, used as a diegetic means to bound Median Reach segments. But dramaturgically those roads are not traveled enough to provide hazard. Discuss.

7.4 "every Median Reach has a Margin in either side." Sentence early here. And for us design wise, the Margin on either side should be the same basic ground type, but have a different personality, hazard level, resource pool.

7.4 discuss "Edge Effect" as a proper named concept, or as an implied sense of how zones work. It seems to resonate too loud for me now, and if there is reason for that help me see.

7.5 expand this: "A Reach has three lifecycle states, described in full in Section 28: **undiscovered**, **discovered-but-expedition-only**, and **outposted**." The three stages need short names and the explanation should be along the lines of "starts unknown. Once it has been scouted, it becomes explorable. Once an outpost has been built; it becomes a colony extension (better name)"

-7.6 "ancestral home visitable as a Special Expedition"

8.1 "There is no separate scrub/briar biome; that flavor folds into the Wooded Median." Lingering Document History

8.1, each Biome should have a larger-than-usual mid-page example diagram or rendering next to its text. Perhaps it's 3-4 biomes per page, text and image half page, alternating side.

8.1 the Edge Effect note here doesn't hold up dramaturgically. Richer plant resources would be in more sheltered central parts.

8.2 implies a gameplay strategy where animals skip out posting certain Median Reaches to hold out for species synergy, instead of building sequentially. Unsure implications of this.

9.0 - Expedition cap globally? Low pop maybe makes that automatic.

9.1 want to make sure night expeditions are not subtly discouraged. I think night is a prime operating time for animals, and GFX should support a bright version of "night"

9.2 an Anomaly Event should a presence in Highway and Margin -- ie a truck crash, cars are stopped, and the Margin is full of truck cargo booty.

9.3 also seems to be not matching real conditions. the Sound Wall side of the Margin should be resource rich as well, dramaturgically, because things there are less disturbed. Maybe it's the character of the nodes / loot that changes. Litter not present on Soundwall edge for example.

10.1 - possible Spring River Spume = Chemical/Fertilizer, possible Autumn River Spume = dust storm (lowers viz?)

10.1 - one Nesting Season or Two? We need a full deep dive on population through tiers, looking at all components.

10.2 - should Road Work affect all Median Reaches at once? I feel they shouldn't be able to retire to an outpost and forage there for the duration.

10.3 - Event Choice Layer should be decoupled from 10.1 & 10.2 and presented earlier. It's a mechanic used throughout the game.

11 - three things grow a colony: wandered, nested young, and Guest Citizens

12 - Role. Possible system change -- should there be Colony Role AND Expedition Role? Should Expeditions have Roles like "Scout" "Leader" etc? If a Negotiation, the Leader Citizen is featured? Perhaps drift and bloat.

12 - Teacher; how does this manifest? Should it be gated by Tier advancement? Not much use right away.

12- yes new citizen starts as a forager.

12- could there be any Hearth benefit here? If both hearth members are assigned the same role, slightly higher efficiency?

12-tool assignment should happen in the Citizen area, not the Colony area. The pool of unused tools is colony wide but tools themselves are extensions of Citizens.

13 - I'd weaken the restrictions for Special Items -- I can see a use where a Citizen equips a Special Item in place of a Tool or Keepsake. In RPG terms, these are "magic items"

13- should crafters be able to make Tools from Scrap?

13 - 1 weight = 1 Slot combined was calibrated off stats with one less exponent. If matching stat scaling, it should be 10 weight = 10 Slot, and normal items should be more than 1 weight. Or else item totals will get large quick. (An Expedition of Squirrels has 60 carry slots)

14 - "Maintenance" as a Scrap draining mechanic.

14 - Different Median Biomes should degrade different buildings faster or slower, slightly.

15.1 - is it too much to have different building names per species?

15.1 - Guest Citizen species profiles should list their dwelling type & location.

15.3 - interesting concept of an ongoing Choice Card. I had imagined as instantaneous resolution, but continuing has interesting possibilities.

Part IV - Citizens Chapter shouldn't be introduced with a Tharn artwork

16 - Character Record should become Citizen Record.

16 - Descriptive Bands need an appendix table

17.1 - permit Trusted Friend bonds between Core and Guest Citizens, but not Hearths.

17.4 - Wanderer should be easy to adopt vs Guest Citizen.

18.1 - An Ameliorated Maiming could either lessen partially the Maim penalty or provide a dramaturgically related boost, of 50% power or negative effect. (Ie lose an eye and hearing gets stronger). Discuss.

18.2 - Tharn should be a bombshell event, immediately centered narratively when

it happens.

18.2 - the rescue of the Tharn state as a means for Friendship Bond requires a citizen level focus in the Encounter cycle. This realization is new to the thinking, although individualizing is introduced here above with Expedition Roles. The consequence of untended Tharn being Citizen "death" (left behind) in a game where Citizen's matter shouldn't happen with normal player behavior -- so the choice is who rescues, not if.

18.2 - Tharn can only occur when there is a possibility for rescue. No final round occurrence, despite increased exposure.

18.2 - Tharn should carry more smaller repercussions. For example, a Citizen brought into Tharn in an encounter should be penalized the next time their encounter that same species.

18.3 - a Distinction should reflect the character of the encounter it was earned in.

18.4 - maybe a note that character stats can also be affected by Items. ?
(Example A Tool item could be a pouch granting 5 Carry)

19 - repeating that Tool assignment should be through the Citizen pipe not Colony.

19 - Tools are permanent with character until changed or deequipped. Supply items are expedition-duration-only.

20 - A Guest has a given name already, and should be known in the Encounter by that name.

GENERAL - I realize I have been picturing an Expedition as 3 Citizens. Never before quantified. Let's discuss.

20 - Active Guests should have Carry Cap and Skill like Core Species, in addition to their unique qualities. They fill a "body" slot and need to provide the same general base utility as a Core member.

20.2 Ambient Guests should be threatened like a Core Citizens during a Colony Hazards.

20.2 - Firefly ability calls into question Time of Day mechanics.

20.2 - Turtle still needs a better skill. Something else patience based.

20.2 - Bat structure preservation should maybe apply to all decay? It's a

dramaturgically stretch but a better utility and one that is not present yet.

20.2 - in a fuller system, the Cultural Focus would be a different boost than just an increase of base skill -- it would flavor the colony somehow. A stretch for now; just mark it for later.

20 - Template Character. We should introduce other unique Guest Citizens. Perhaps three different members of different species? They should be woven into the narrative of one of the three story Colonies:

20.3 - Confirm Raccoon, Weasel, Hedgehog as species that can be antagonistic or Guest. No need to discuss Rat at all; Rat should appear on a table of antagonist species only.

20.4 - Single Species Colony (no cross core recruitment) doesn't need to be called out because we provide a list of recruitable Guests and the core species aren't on it. A reader would never assume otherwise, absent Document History.

20.4 - remove entirely the Guest clothing thing. Guests Citizens are anthropomorphized to the exact same degree as Core.

21.2 - Likeness View should be the equivalent of a Character Equip screen. We see their image, and their slots, and their particulars, and can change changeable things there (such as Role or Tool)

22.1 - remove "Chosen" nobody chooses their names (normally). The Guest comes with one already. (They can still earn After-name as per any Citizen)

22.2 - this is the "After-name" of a place.

GENERAL STYLE: I want to adopt an unusual grammar styling, as a Tolkien tribute. Tolkien does a thing where he has hyphenated word pairs, with the initial word capitalized, and a theory is that seeing that indicates a concept that was one single word in the original language but needs two in English. **Tolkien's capitalized hyphen-compounds often represent concepts that are imagined as single, established words or titles within Middle-earth. The English "translation" separates their semantic components so that readers can understand them, while the hyphen and capitalization preserve their unity and cultural weight.**

22:3 - noted earlier in this to add a choice for a Tribute or Memorial name option.

23.1 Crossing is "a" signature mechanic, not "the" signature mechanic.

23.2 residual Document History: "*(This 70/20/10 split supersedes the earlier 80/10/10 hypothesis.)*"

23.1 - multiple Nodes in an Expedition after the first should get harder in that there should be tied in to Carry Usage (if the party is weighed down, they're less agile)

24.4 - explain this: "The same Field Mode is **reused, not rebuilt bespoke**, across every destination. The expedition types differ in what persists and what the party is there to do, not in a separate traversal engine each."

24.4 - I feel Encounter contest should be possible on Hone Reach but decrease with each Tier. Future developed Bird Hazard wouldn't lessen like that.

25.1 - Discussed already that default Encounter should include a Player Choice moment. I'd almost go as strong as to say "always" and eliminate 1-round-0-choice Encounters as uninteresting. *exception there's a chance of instant resolution for uncontested resource encounters only.

25.1 - Can players at the Choice Moment between rounds change Approach? Negotiate after Fight etc.

25.3 - adversary party size and individuals can be depicted artistically for compelling imagery. They're just not gameplay relevant.

25.8 - Carry Cap is a natural way to end Expeditions and keep Players from going Node to Node. This reduces the creep warned of here.

26.1 - Antagonist/Non-Antagonist ratio should be variable with conditions.

26.1 - This is why I think Names should be known in Encounters even before adoption happens. **"The same animal that drove a party off a node last season can be sitting at the Story Circle this one."**

27.1 - There should be a means to Margin Raid from a Median Reach that's not the Home Median, if an Outpost and Staging Post are constructed.

27.1 - Special Journey. Let's formalize examples both now, and explicitly call out that this is a hook for future extensibility. The two explicit examples would be gated to Tier 2 or above.

28.1 better names needed for territory state, called out earlier above.

28.2 add Staging Post to this list; to permit Margin Raids from this Reach.

28.3 this implies that in an Outpost, the Citizen always has a Forager-equivalent function. Home Colony Roles don't make sense out here. Perhaps there is a smaller set of Outpost Roles (~3) that apply in Outposts.

31- Document History "**Tier III must not be named for or structurally dependent on the Rest-Stop Metropolis.**" The Metropolis's own history and mythology is worldbuilding and creates no dependency here.

31.1 Advancement Resources need to get the same 10x jump as other stats. Regardless it should be a quite significant cost to upgrade.

33.1 - Should reject explicit metal medievalist (swords) but "staves" and "cloaks" and "pouches" should not be as discouraged as they currently are. I like some amount of visual signifier like this.

33.1 - Back off the No-Clothes rule. Outfit forms a part of Player's conception of a Citizen, and I don't want to lessen that at home.

33.1 - The Crossing is explicitly four-legged. Other places should allow bipedalism in favor of compelling imagery.

33.1 "Role is never worn" cuts against "Ledger and Legible". Unsure what this implies but noting it.

33.1 - want to solidify an explicit ban on Metal Medievalism, but permit things like Leaf Helmets, Cloth scrap cloaks, Staves in hand, etc.

33.3 - Remove Audio altogether now that this is a Concept Book not an actualized production GDD?

34- Image Generation Layer will require dedicated development discussion. I have back-end ideas as well as front end. Placeholder for later.

35- Founding Escape story to be personalized around one of our example Colonies. I'd say choose one Species for a lush narrative version, and the other two as short summaries, to be referenced later.